Tenure data gameplan (mutually agreed plan)

What this file is: The **forward-looking contract** for what we **will** accomplish in the **PEER** empirical setting (CS faculty tenure at R1 institutions) and **how** it connects to the inverted-U thesis (Army CODA, basketball SCOUT, academia). It is **strategic**: outcomes, stages, durable artifacts, and advisor alignment. **Algorithmic detail**—how each notebook cell reads and writes specific `.csv` / `.jsonl` / `.py` files—is in `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md` (the "pipeline map"). `540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb` is the **conductor** at the workspace root; heavy logic lives in `tenure_pipeline/` modules where possible.

Lineage: Narrative builds on `Pertinent_Thoughts_Tenure.md`, prior PEER design notes, and the live pipeline described in `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md`. The sports parallel is `../sports_documents/SPORTS_DATA_GAMEPLAN.md`: same split—**gameplan = intent and stage contract**, **overview + notebook = implementation wiring**.

Working agreement (process)

1. **Gameplan vs overview:** `TENURE_DATA_GAMEPLAN.md` (this file) stays **stable and readable**—goals, stage boundaries, durable files, open questions. `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md` carries **cell-level** behavior, flags, checkpoints, and file schemas as the implementation reference. For **stable handles** to each `##` section here (**§G1–§G14** + front matter), see `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md` **§0**.
2. **Document first for big design changes:** If a stage's *meaning* changes (e.g. tenure vs attrition definition), update **this gameplan** (or an advisor memo), then align code/notebook.
3. **Snapshots:** The repo and `tenure_pipeline/` hold truth; obsolete or one-off experiments should live under clearly named archive folders, not mixed into canonical outputs.
4. **Panel time semantics & collisions (implementation detail):** Use **exact Wayback timestamps** (derive e.g. `snpsht_dt`) as the **analysis clock** for ordering and `merge_asof`; treat `year` / `season` as **CDX culling strata**, not substitutes for observation time. For **duplicate or ambiguous names**, allow **multiplicity**, **blending**, and **conflict flags** for later QA—`faculty_linker` is a **baseline** path, not the only defensible representation. See `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md` **§5** (subsections *Temporal keys* and *Collisions*).
5. **Fix plumbing early:** Structural mistakes in scrape/plan/panel **do not get clearer with age**. Prefer correcting **identity, retention, and join logic** close to when we touch that stage—then re-run—rather than "someday" after results exist.

Snapshot identity, retention, and season labels

Primary key for a Wayback observation is the **Archive capture timestamp** (and the corresponding `wayback_url` / derived `snpsht_dt`). `year` + `season` **(spring/fall)** are **useful derived labels**—e.g. for heatmaps, stratification, and CDX query bands—but they are **not** a substitute for a continuous timeline.

Retention: Through ingest and parse, **do not discard** captures merely because another capture exists in the same nominal season. Prefer **many dated observations**; **algorithmic consolidation** (median week, dedupe rules, event logic) is a **downstream** step with logged assumptions—not an early filter.

CDX / plan (Cells 3A–3B): The pipeline requests **up to** `CDX_SNAPS_PER_SEASON` **distinct captures per (calendar year, season band)** (default **12** in CELL 0; see overview). When more CDX rows exist than that cap, the closest `CDX_SPACING_POOL_MULT` **× cap** to the

season anchor are pooled, sorted in time, then **evenly subsampled** so captures are spread across the year. Each selected capture has a **unique on-disk name** including the Wayback `timestamp`. **More snapshots is better** until a later phase explicitly summarizes; overnight runs are acceptable.

What counts as "tried" for CDX: CELL 3A builds `tried_urls` **only from** `faculty_snapshots_plan.jsonl` (plus `tried_primary_url` / `tried_urls` fields on prior rows). Deleting or archiving that file (and, for a full Wayback reset, `cdx_retry_queue.jsonl`, `faculty_snapshots_index.jsonl`, `faculty_snapshots/`, and downstream parse/panel JSONL) makes URLs **untried** again for the next run. Removing HTML alone does not reset the plan.

3A → 3A-RETRY spacing: The notebook includes an optional **bridge cell** after 3A-VIZ: displays a short **hourglass** message and sleeps `CDX_SLEEP_BEFORE_RETRY_SEC` (default 30 minutes) before you run **CELL 3A-RETRY**, so the Archive gets a breather between pass 1 and the slow retry pass.

Option B on disk (naming): `faculty_snapshots/<uni_slug>/<source_id>/<year>_<season>_<timestamp>.html` (legacy two-part `year_season.html` filenames may still appear until rebuilt).

Target architecture: 540 as pipeline conductor

Intent: `540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb` is the **single entry point** you run for the scrape → parse → (future) match → panel chain. Cells are gated by `RUN_CELL*` flags in Cell 0 (see overview).

Role	Responsibility
`tenure_pipeline/*.py`	Parsers (`html_parser.py`), URL helpers (`apply_url_updates.py`), utilities; importable, testable units.
`540` **notebook**	Orchestration: load constants, run stages in order, checkpoint/resume, thin cells that call into `.py` where factored.
Human loops	URL research → `url_update_worksheet.csv` → `apply_url_updates.py` → `r1_schools_data.py`; optional QA CSVs for match overrides when entity resolution lands.

Why this fits: Matches **document-first** staging, **append-only** plan/index JSONL, and your preference for **one conductor** instead of scattered one-off notebooks.

Outcomes we want

- **Empirical:** A defensible longitudinal panel of CS faculty at R1 departments with **rank / presence** from Wayback snapshots and **publication-based performance** from bibliographic data (OpenAlex and/or DBLP—see stages below).
- **Thesis-facing:** Measures that support an **inverted-U** test: tenure or promotion success vs **leave–self-out peer pool quality** (and related peer-group definitions), analogous to Army and basketball designs.
- **Operational:** Reproducible **HTML archive** per planned snapshot, **parsed** roster records, then **matched** people to author IDs, then **panel** rows with explicit **sample-loss accounting** at each filter (advisor: "track how many people you throw away at every point").

- **Coverage: Full R1 CS roster in the plan** is a **publication-time** goal; **near-term** priority (advisor, Apr 2026) is **quality and end-to-end statistics on the current corpus**, not maximizing scrape breadth every week.

Durable team / URL equity (files on disk)

Intent: Treat these as **durable inputs**, not disposable cache—extend when QA shows gaps.

File (location)	Role
`tenure_pipeline/r1_schools_data.py`	**Source of truth** for `PILOT_SCHOOLS` and per-school `urls[]`.
`tenure_pipeline/r1_cs_departments.csv`	CSV emitted by Cell 2 from the Python list—downstream convenience.
`tenure_pipeline/url_update_worksheet.csv`	Human-edited queue for new/changed URLs; drives `apply_url_updates.py`.
`tenure_pipeline/faculty_snapshots_plan.jsonl`	Append-only CDX plan + sentinels (`n_snaps`, bookmarks, reasons)—see overview for semantics; **sole driver of "tried" URLs** for 3A skip logic.
`tenure_pipeline/cdx_retry_queue.jsonl`	URLs that timed out in 3A pass 1; consumed by **CELL 3A-RETRY** (clear when doing a full clean slate).
`tenure_pipeline/faculty_snapshots_index.jsonl`	Per-download audit (HTTP status, bytes, paths).
`tenure_pipeline/faculty_snapshots_parsed.jsonl`	Parsed faculty rows (Cell 4).
`tenure_pipeline/faculty_panel.jsonl`	Longitudinal within-school panel + Wayback timestamps (Cell 5); see overview §5.
`tenure_pipeline/faculty_panel_collisions.jsonl`	Name-key collision QA (Cell 5).
`tenure_pipeline/dblp_parsed/*.jsonl`	Per-year DBLP extracts (Cell 1).
`tenure_pipeline/school_enrollment_annual.csv`	IPEDS fall headcount by school × year (for viz; rebuild `541` / `build_school_enrollment_from_ipeds.py`).
`tenure_pipeline/openalex_*.json` / `*.jsonl`	Cells 6A–6B outputs when run (institution map, author IDs, works-by-year, low-confidence queue).

Option B on disk: `faculty_snapshots/<uni_slug>/<source_id>/<year>_<season>_<timestamp>.html` (multi-capture) or legacy `<year>_<season>.html`; `source_id = faculty_source_id(url)`—see overview.

Stage map (high level)

Stage	Notebook region	Intent	Key outputs	Detail
0	Cell 0	Flags, paths, imports	—	Overview §2
1	Cell 1	DBLP XML → yearly JSONL	`tenure_pipeline/dblp_parsed/`	Overview §3
2	Cell 2	Schools list → CSV	`r1_cs_departments.csv`	Overview §3
3A–3E	Cells 3A–3E (+ optional bridge before 3A-RETRY)	CDX plan, Wayback download, optional rescues	`faculty_snapshots_plan.jsonl`, HTML tree, `cdx_retry_queue.jsonl`, indexes	Overview §3–4
4	Cell 4	Parse HTML → names/ranks	`faculty_snapshots_parsed.jsonl`	Overview §4
5	Cell 5	Within-school longitudinal panel + Wayback plan join (`snpsht_dt`, etc.)	`faculty_panel.jsonl`, `faculty_panel_collisions.jsonl`	Overview §4
6A–6B	Cells 6A–6B	OpenAlex institution + author resolution + works-by-year (API)	`openalex_*.json` / `*.jsonl`	Overview §4
7+	Future cells	Enriched panel, pool metrics, analysis	enriched `faculty_panel.*`, figures	Overview §4 planned

Full **sentinel rules**, **CDX timeouts**, **3B ghost retries**, and **parser strategies** are **not** duplicated here—see `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md`.

Advisor direction — 2026-04-09 conversation (Alex Gates)

Source: `2-Way_Ahead/20260410_Paper_directions_4_otter_ai.pdf` *(Otter transcript). Summarized for implementation alignment.*

1. **Priority shift (next ~week):** The scrape/plan machinery is in good shape. **Do not** treat "add more schools / URLs" as the main task **right now**. Shift time toward **quality and measurement on existing data**: how many **assistant → associate** transitions you can see, how much **attrition** (assistant disappears without associate), and rough **peer-group** definitions you can actually populate.
2. **You do not need the full 187-school scrape today**—you need enough structure to estimate effects and see whether the **inverted-U** is plausible; **defend the sample** at publication time.
3. **Core ingredients to plan explicitly:** (a) **success metric**—tenure / promotion to associate; (b) **peer group(s)**—nested definitions (immediate peers vs broader assistant cohorts—flexible, characterize alternatives); (c) **performance metric**—publications/citations via **OpenAlex** (and ORCID for disambiguation); expect to **try several** specifications.
4. **Faculty-per-snapshot distribution:** Treat as **department pool size**; very large counts may include non–tenure-track listings—**filter later**, but start measuring.
5. **Name matching (v0):** Basic **within-school / within-department** consistency before exotic global merges.
6. **OpenAlex at scale:** Prefer **bulk** OpenAlex (UVA **Connected Data Hub** / HPC: `.csv.gz` table shards—authors, works, author–work–affiliation) over hand-fixing author IDs for subsets; **do not** manually merge three OpenAlex IDs unless the same rule can apply **everywhere** (otherwise bias). **Status (Apr 2026):** bulk snapshot access is **not yet provisioned**; Stage **6A–6B** use the **API** (`openalex_resolver.py`) until a mount path exists. See `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md` **§4** + transcript `2-Way_Ahead/20260410_Paper_directions_4_otter_ai.pdf`.
7. **Sanity check literature:** Use **Dakota**-style tenure/productivity work (and any shared **tenure rates**) only to compare **orders of magnitude**—not as the main theoretical anchor.
8. **Field: CS** aligns with DBLP; if linkage rates collapse, **other hard sciences** are acceptable—decide on evidence.
9. **Working style:** Drive toward a **first end-to-end curve** (even with messy data); **log sample loss** at each filter; **re-run the pipeline** after a day of cleaning rather than cleaning for a week without integrated results. (Rough time split discussed: **most** time on getting the model through; **small** slice on new URLs / edge HTML.)

Stage 1 — DBLP parse (Cell 1)

We will keep per-year JSONL under `tenure_pipeline/dblp_parsed/` as the canonical bibliographic spine for author names/years to match against later stages. Analysis window for publications may be a subset of years on disk.

Stage 2 — R1 school list (Cell 2)

We will maintain `r1_schools_data.py` as the authoritative list of departments and `urls[]`, rebuild `r1_cs_departments.csv` from Cell 2 after edits, and use `apply_url_updates.py` + the worksheet for controlled URL changes.

Stage 3 — Wayback scrape (Cells 3A–3E)

We will discover snapshots via CDX (3A), download HTML (3B), and use **optional** rescue cells (3C–3E) where archived pages are shells—documented in the overview. **Goal:** durable HTML + plan/index lines suitable for Cell 4.

Stage 4 — HTML parse (Cell 4)

We will parse all `*.html` under each school directory (Option B + `legacy/`) into `faculty_snapshots_parsed.jsonl`, with strategy audit. **Capture broad titles**; narrow to tenure-track populations at analysis time.

Stages 6–9 — Match, enriched panel, pools, analysis (planned)

We will (order subject to refinement):

Piece	Intent
Entity resolution	Faculty names ↔ **OpenAlex** (Cells 6A–6B in `540`; `openalex_resolver.py`) with **scalable** rules; DBLP JSONL for cross-checks; optional QA CSV for overrides. **Bulk** OpenAlex at UVA when access exists.
Panel	`(person × year)` (or equivalent) with rank transitions, attrition flags, and publication metrics.
Peer quality	Leave–self–out (or pre-specified) pool metrics on agreed performance measure.
Inference / EDA	Binned tenure rates vs pool quality, regressions / survival as pre-specified—inverted-U read first.

Exact notebook cell numbers and file names will be frozen in `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md` as cells land.

Fast path — first inverted-U checkpoint (dirty OK)

Purpose: See whether **tenure (or promotion) rate** vs **peer pool quality** shows a **nonlinear** pattern early, before perfecting every linkage.

Rule: Do not delete canonical under `tenure_pipeline/` while experimenting; write scratch outputs with dated suffixes if needed.

Checklist (adapted from sports gameplan logic)

- [ ] **Inputs:** Parsed rosters + at least a v0 **panel** slice with rank and year; some **performance** column (even crude pub counts).

- ☐ **Define v0 outcomes:** assistant→associate within window; **disappear** from roster without promotion (attrition)—document assumptions.
- ☐ **Define v0 peer pool:** e.g. LOO mean pubs among assistants in same dept-year (or advisor-agreed variant).
- ☐ **Bins:** ventiles/deciles of pool quality; compute event rates + N per bin; plot.
- ☐ **Save artifacts:** dated figure + CSV of binned table + one paragraph of definitions.
- ☐ **Optional:** LPM with pool + pool² as sign check.

If the shape is null, that is still a **result**—inform peer-group and metric choices before heavy polish.

Open points (negotiate next)

- Exact **peer-group** definitions and robustness set.
- **OpenAlex vs DBLP** weighting for performance; handling of missing authors.
- **Attrition** vs **move** (other institution) when snapshots lack national placement data.
- Panel **grain** and **tenure-clock** window for "success."
- When to resume aggressive **coverage** expansion vs **analysis** lock-in.

Document history

- **2026-04-03 — 2026-04-08:** Earlier iterations of `TENURE_DATA_GAMEPLAN.md` (roster size, sentinels, URL workflow, Cell 3A-RETRY)—superseded in structure by this file; technical detail preserved in `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md`.
- **2026-04-10: Restructured to mirror** `SPORTS_DATA_GAMEPLAN.md`: split **gameplan** vs **overview**; added **Advisor direction (2026-04-09)** from Otter transcript; condensed duplicate cell-by-cell specs in favor of cross-links to `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md`.
- **2026-04-10 (later):** Working agreement item 1 points to `TENURE_PIPELINE_OVERVIEW.md` **§0** for **§G1–§G14** stable anchors to each `##` heading here.
- **2026-04 (later):** Working agreement item **4** summarizes **§5** in the overview (*Temporal keys*, *Collisions*) so the gameplan stays the strategic hook without duplicating that text.
- **2026-04 (later):** Stage map row **5** = Cell 5 panel outputs; durable-files table adds `faculty_panel.jsonl` / `faculty_panel_collisions.jsonl`.
- **2026-04-10: Snapshot identity & retention** + **fix plumbing early** (working agreement **5**); Option B filename pattern allows **timestamp** suffix; CDX multi-capture per season band—see overview **§3** / **§5**.
- **2026-04-11:** CDX cap **12** per band + **temporal spacing** when many candidates; `tried_urls` / clean-slate semantics; `cdx_retry_queue.jsonl` in durable files; **3A→3A-RETRY bridge** (`CDX_SLEEP_BEFORE_RETRY_SEC`, hourglass cell)—see overview **§2–§3**.
- **2026-04-11 (later):** `Pertinent_Thoughts_Tenure.md` shortened: dissertation-facing notes only; stale operational counts and duplicate pipeline detail removed; **NC State** status in overview de-"pending" in favour of re-run guidance.
- **2026-04-12:** OpenAlex **bulk snapshot at UVA** — access **pending**; Stage **6A–6B** documented as **API** path; durable-files table adds `school_enrollment_annual.csv` + `openalex_*`; advisor bullet 6 links to overview **§4** + Otter transcript; stage map rows **6A–6B** / **7+**; **Stages 6–9** table names OpenAlex + bulk.